

4. Turning Off System Restore

Windows XP comes with the System Restore feature, which allows you to roll the system back to a previously defined state. (Refer chapter 9 for more on System Restore.) This feature comes in handy when a driver installation fails and the system crashes, in which case the system can be rolled back to the earlier state with a few clicks. By default, this service monitors almost all the partitions on your hard drives, and allocates a whopping 12 per cent of partition space for its activities.

If you're a first-time user, we'd suggest you keep System Restore running on, at least on your primary (OS) partition, if not the entire hard disk(s). But if you're an experienced user, there's no need to keep this service running.



Turning off System Restore on all drives

In the 'System Properties' page, select the 'System Restore' tab. By default, System Restore is turned on and monitors each drive. To turn it off, check the box 'Turn off system restore on all drives'.

To selectively keep System Restore running on a particular drive, on the 'System Restore' page, select the appropriate drive and click the 'Settings' button. Drag the slider to set the space that System Restore will take up. 5 per cent to 7 per cent should be good enough for a home PC.

5. Turn Off The Indexing service

The Indexing Service creates a database of files on your hard drive. When you search for a file, XP searches for the file's location in this database and reports its location. The database it constantly